

The Wall Mobility *Self-Check*

Two quick tests you can run at home, against any wall, in under five minutes — no equipment beyond a tape measure and your own two feet.

Your ankles and shoulders set the ceiling for almost everything you do under load — squatting, running, lifting overhead, landing. **These two wall tests give you an honest baseline** for both, so you know exactly what to work on before you add more reps, more weight, or more mileage. Grab a tape measure, find a bare wall, and run through both.

TEST 01 Ankle dorsiflexion • relevant for squatting, running, jumping

KNEE-TO-WALL ANKLE MOBILITY TEST

Ankle dorsiflexion test • Relevant for squatting, running, jumping

1 SET UP

Kneel in a half-kneeling position facing a wall. Front foot flat, back knee down on a cushion.



2 MOVE FORWARD

Keeping your front heel glued to the floor, drive your front knee forward toward the wall.

Go as close as you can while keeping your heel down and foot flat.



Keep your heel down and your foot flat at all times.



3 CHECK YOUR RANGE

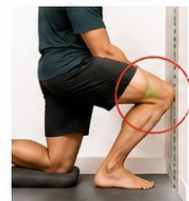
See how close your knee can get to the wall.

If your knee **touches the wall**, it's a **PASS**.

If your knee **does NOT** touch the wall, it's a **FAIL**.



TOUCH
= PASS



NO TOUCH
= FAIL

PASS



Your knee touches the wall while your heel stays down and your foot stays flat.



FAIL



Your knee does **NOT** touch the wall while your heel stays down and your foot stays flat.



TIPS

- If your heel lifts before your knee reaches the wall, shuffle your foot slightly closer and retest. If your knee taps the wall easily, shuffle back.
- Repeat on the other side — most people have a small difference between feet, which is normal and worth noting.

WHAT YOU'RE READING

The distance you land on is a rough gauge of ankle dorsiflexion. A shorter distance (heel lifts early) points to a stiffer ankle; a longer distance shows more range to work with under load.

< 5 cm
limited

5-10 cm
moderate

> 10 cm
good range

Side view — front knee tracks toward the wall while the heel stays planted

- 1 Kneel in a half-kneeling position facing a wall, front foot flat, back knee down on a cushion.
- 2 Start with your front toes about 10cm (4in) from the wall.
- 3 Keeping your front heel glued to the floor, drive your front knee forward to try to tap the wall.
- 4 If your heel lifts before your knee reaches the wall, shuffle your foot slightly closer and retest. If your knee taps the wall easily, shuffle back.
- 5 Find the greatest toe-to-wall distance where your knee can still touch the wall without your heel lifting. Measure that distance.
- 6 Repeat on the other side — most people have a small difference between feet, which is normal and worth noting.

WHAT YOU'RE READING

The distance you land on is a rough gauge of ankle dorsiflexion. A shorter distance (heel lifts early) points to a stiffer ankle; a longer distance shows more range to work with under load.

< 5cm — limited

5-10cm — moderate

> 10cm — good range



TEST 02

Shoulder flexion · relevant for overhead pressing, handstands, backbends

WALL SHOULDER FLEXION TEST

Shoulder flexion test · Relevant for overhead pressing, handstands, backbends

1 SET UP

Stand with your head, upper back, and sacrum (not low back) against the wall.

Feet a few centimetres forward.



2 RAISE ARMS OVERHEAD

Gently flatten your low back toward the wall (avoid arching — a small natural gap is fine).

Raise both arms overhead, backs of your hands trying to stay in contact with the wall the whole way up.

Keep your ribs down and low back gently flattened.



3 CHECK YOUR RANGE

See how high your hands can travel while keeping all three contact points on the wall.

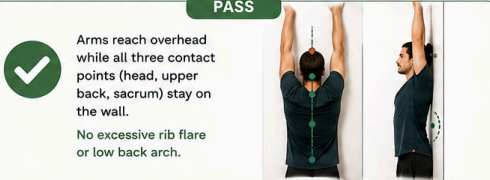
Mark or estimate the highest point your hands reach while all three contact points stay on the wall.



PASS

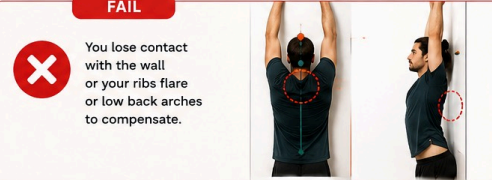
Arms reach overhead while all three contact points (head, upper back, sacrum) stay on the wall.

No excessive rib flare or low back arch.



FAIL

You lose contact with the wall or your ribs flare or low back arches to compensate.



TIPS

- Avoid forcing or shrugging your shoulders.
- Keep your ribs down and core engaged.
- This test is about quality range, not just how high you can reach.

WHAT YOU'RE READING

This test isolates true shoulder flexion from the compensation most people use instead — arching the low back to fake extra range. Losing wall contact early is more informative than the height itself.

Arms stay on wall to ~ear level or beyond — good range

Side view — three points of contact, arm reaching overhead along the wall line

- 1 Stand with your head, upper back, and sacrum (not your low back) against the wall, feet a few centimetres forward of the wall.
- 2 Gently flatten your low back toward the wall without forcing it — a small natural gap is fine, just avoid arching.
- 3 Raise both arms overhead, backs of your hands trying to stay in contact with the wall the whole way up.
- 4 Notice the point where your arms lose contact with the wall, or where your ribs flare and your low back arches to compensate.



- 5 Mark or estimate how high your hands travelled while all three contact points held — that's your working shoulder flexion range.

WHAT YOU'RE READING

This test isolates true shoulder flexion from the compensation most people use instead — arching the low back to fake extra range. Losing wall contact early is more informative than the height itself.

Arms stay on wall to ~ear level or beyond — good range

Ribs flare / back arches before ear level — restricted

How did you score?

Save a photo of yourself running either test, tag it, and send it over — we'll tell you what it means for your practice and where to start.

These are general self-screening tools, not a medical diagnosis. If either test reproduces sharp or lasting pain, stop and check in with a healthcare professional before continuing.

FIND & FIX MOBILITY METHOD™